Dhāraṇī for Retaining the Noble Sūtra The King of Samādhis

Toh 942 · Derge Kangyur

The Dhāraṇī for Retaining the Noble Sūtra The King of Samādhis is a very brief incantation connected to the great Mahāyāna scripture known in Sanskrit as the Samādhirāja Sūtra and in Tibetan as the Ting nge 'dzin gyi rgyal po, the King of Samādhis. After an opening homage to the Three Jewels, it gives a single short mantra invoking the buddhas, whose teaching is said to be unobstructed, and closes with the promise that whoever retains this formula will thereby retain the King of Samādhis sūtra itself. Texts of this kind serve as condensed essences of longer scriptures, allowing a practitioner to hold the power and blessing of an entire sūtra through the recitation of a few syllables. It is catalogued as Toh 942 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī texts, the collection of spells and incantations gathered within the canon.

Homage to the Three Jewels!

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ apratihata śāsanānāṃ oṃ dhuna dhuna hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā

By retaining this, one will retain the noble sūtra The King of Samādhis.

This completes the dhāraṇī for retaining the noble sūtra The King of Samādhis.

Translator's Notes

• "Retaining" renders the verb that also means "holding" or "keeping in memory." The sense is that reciting this dhāraṇī is equivalent to keeping the whole sūtra in mind. The sūtra named is the Samādhirājasūtra. The final syllable of the colophon, written "sho," is read as the usual closing particle "so."

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.